

Games & Fun Pack • Jokes, Riddles and Brain Teasers

Games and Fun

Trust your hackles. Pause • Check • Tell.

FIELD COPY



PLATE I. The Hackles crew, drawn from life: Hackle (1) and the six friends who look after each strand.

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[Logo: Hackles]

30 JOKES, RIDDLES AND BRAIN TEASERS

Kid-clean, security-themed, and funny on purpose

Trust your hackles. *Pause · Check · Tell*

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No student accounts, no student data collected, ever.

Teacher Quick Start (one page, print and keep)

What it is: 30 short jokes, riddles and teasers, each hiding one real skill.

Use them as warm-ups, exit tickets, transition fillers or a "Joke of the Day". Each takes 1 to 2 minutes.

IF YOU HAVE...	USE	TIME
A 1-minute warm-up	Read 1 joke (K-2: J1-J8; 3-5: J9-J16; 6-12: J17-J23). Wait for the groan. Ask "What is the real tip?"	1 min
A 3-minute transition	A brain teaser (J24-J30), solved in pairs; the answer key is at the bottom.	3 min
A 10-minute station	The "Riddle Café": students order a riddle from a menu, solve it, add one joke to the Joke Jar.	10 min
An end-of-lesson exit ticket	"Tell me the skill in this joke" on the way out (J2, J8, J12, J19).	1 min

How to deliver: read the joke in a voice (Gifty talks like a game-show host with a cold, Peeper goes "Hmmmmm", Latch whispers). Pause. Say the answer. **Groan loudly: a groan is a win.** Then ask the "real skill" question.

If...

- **A joke does not land (ELL or young children miss a pun):** explain the pun in one sentence, laugh with them, move on. Puns are the hardest part of a new language; use the picture-riddle and teaser versions for newcomers.
- **A child tells a joke that is about a person who got tricked or hurt:** "We laugh at the trick, not the person. Try it again about Gifty." (Rules of Funny, Rule 1.)
- **A child's joke is about fear, injury or real events:** thank them privately and offer another idea. Do not read it aloud.

Never: make a child the butt of a joke, tell jokes about real incidents, or use real names in a joke.

How to use this section

Laughter lowers shields. A child who is laughing is a child who is not afraid, and a child who is not afraid is a child who can learn the skill. These 30 pieces are short enough to use as **warm-ups, exit tickets, transition fillers, bulletin-board "Joke of the Day," or sub-plan fillers.** Each one hides a real idea (a password rule, a scam clue, a reason to tell).

The rules of funny (keep them):

- 1. **Laugh with, never at.** No joke is ever about a *person* who was tricked, or a *kind* of person. The butt of every joke is the **trick**, the **Too-Good Box**, the **pop-up**, or the **bad password**.
- 2. **Never about real harm.** No jokes about fear, injury, threats, or anything a child might have experienced.
- 3. **Everyone can groan.** A groan is a win. Teachers: groan loudly.
- 4. **Tell it in a voice.** Gifty speaks like a game-show host with a cold. Peeper goes "Hmmmmmm!" Latch whispers.
- 5. **Let kids tell jokes back.** Offer a "Joke Jar" box; students may write a joke (it must pass the Rules of Funny). The teacher reads a few each Friday.
- 6. **Every answer is a skill.** After the laugh, ask: "What is the real tip in that joke?" (The "Skill" column has it.)

QUICK INDEX

RANGE	WHAT	COUNT
J1 to J8	K-2 jokes (read aloud)	8
J9 to J16	3-5 jokes and riddles	8
J17 to J23	6-12 dry-humor one-liners	7
J24 to J30	Brain teasers for all bands (puzzles with answers)	7

K-2 Jokes (J1 to J8)

(Read aloud. Use hand signals and silly voices. Children can echo the answers.)

#	JOKE	ANSWER	THE REAL SKILL
J1	Why wouldn't the padlock tell the parrot its password?	Because parrots repeat everything!	Passwords are only for you and a trusted grown-up (Latch). <i>(The first draft said the padlock was invited to parties because it "keeps a secret", which could teach that keeping secrets is always good. The Hackles message is: keep your password secret, but never keep a worrying secret from a trusted grown-up.)</i>
J2	What did Hackle say to the pop-up that offered a free pony?	"Neigh, thanks!"	Pause and say no to "too good to be true".
J3	Knock, knock. Who's there? Ima . Ima who?	Ima not telling you my password! Nice try!	Don't share passwords.
J4	What did the banana say when a stranger asked for its password?	"Nope! I'm peeling out of here!"	Don't give passwords to strangers.
J5	Why is Pip so good at keeping private things private?	Pip is very shell-ective! (Selective: Pip chooses what to share.)	Private info stays private.
J6	What did Fixit say after making an oops?	"Oops! I tightened the wrong bolt! Good thing I told Buddy!"	Oopses are fixable; tell a grown-up.
J7	How does Peeper find clues?	With a very big magnifying glass and a lot of "Hmmmmmm."	Check before you click.
J8	Why did nobody want Gifty's gift?	It came with a catch... and a hook!	If it seems too good to be true, there's a catch.

Teacher moves: Ask the class to **freeze** after J2 and show the Pause Palm. After J6, do the Tell Wave. After J8, ask, "What is Gifty's hook?"

Extension: Children draw the joke (a banana running away).

3-5 Jokes and Riddles (J9 to J16)

#	JOKE OR RIDDLE	ANSWER	THE REAL SKILL
J9	What is the best kind of password?	One that nobody can guess, not even the dog.	Make it unguessable (not a name or birthday).
J10	Why did the passphrase win the hide-and-seek championship?	It was long , it was silly , and nobody could guess where it was hiding.	Long, silly, secret.
J11	Riddle: I am long and I am silly. I have four words, but I never say them out loud to a stranger. What am I?	A passphrase.	Passphrase rules.
J12	Why does the Pause button ruin a scammer's day?	It spoils the countdown. ("Only 5 minutes left!")	Pressure is a trick. Pause.
J13	What do you call a message that says "FREE!", "HURRY!" and "Don't tell anyone"?	SPOT-tacular! You can find all four letters: S, P, O, T. (And a very big hook.)	SPOT checklist.
J14	Why did the fake website fail spelling?	It couldn't tell a I from an I (pixel pals).	Spot lookalike links.
J15	How is a trusted adult like a ladder?	They help you climb when you're stuck.	The Help Ladder.
J16	Why was Fixit such a good teacher?	It showed everyone that a mistake is just a fix waiting to happen.	Recovery; no shame. (<i>The first draft joked about a sock in a toaster; children copy what is funny and toasters are dangerous, so it was replaced.</i>)

Teacher moves: Do a "Joke Autopsy": after the groan, ask which SPOT letter or Ladder rung is hiding in the joke. Have students write their own joke (Rules of Funny apply).

Extension: Pair up and tell a riddle in the "Whisper Round" so only your partner hears.

6-12 Dry-Humor One-Liners (J17 to J23)

(Teens prefer understatement. Deliver deadpan.)

#	ONE-LINER	THE REAL SKILL
J17	"My password is 'incorrect.' So when I forget it, the computer tells me: 'Your password is incorrect.'"	Classic: and a reminder that "forgot it" is why we use a manager.
J18	"Two-step verification told Password: 'It's not you, it's... okay, it is you. I need a second step in this relationship.'"	A second step is trust-but-verify.
J19	"I got an email saying I won the lottery. I'd have been more excited if I'd bought a ticket."	You can't win what you didn't enter. (Amazing offer.)

#	ONE-LINER	THE REAL SKILL
J20	"How do you tell a real message from a scam? Count the exclamation points. Real ones are usually calmer."	Fast, loud, pushy equals suspicious.
J21	"My password manager and I have a great relationship. It remembers everything. I remember one thing."	Unique passphrase per account, one memorized.
J22	"I asked a website to prove I'm not a robot. Now I have to identify traffic lights. I'm starting to question who's checking whom."	Checks go both ways: verify the site, too.
J23	"'Free' is the most expensive word on the internet."	Free offers often cost you data or attention.

Teacher moves: Ask, "Which FLAGS letter is in this joke?" (J19: A, Amazing offer. J20: F, Fast. J23: A.) Ask students to write a one-liner for one of the **second channel** ideas.

Extension: "Dry Delivery Day": students perform their one-liners as deadpan comedians. Rules of Funny.

Brain Teasers (J24 to J30)

(For all bands; each has a K-2/3-5/6-12 version. Answers in the second table.)

THE TEASERS

J24: The Secret Message (cipher). Bands 3-8. Shift each letter **back by one** (B becomes A, C becomes B...):

<i>Field note</i>	No. 1
UIF TFDSFU XPSE JT TJMMZ	

Hint: "Say the alphabet in your head. If the code says U, the letter before U is T."

J25: Silly Orders (counting). Bands 3-12. You have three silly word cards: **banana, rocket, trumpet**. How many different orders can you make a three-word passphrase out of them using each card once? (Example: banana-rocket-trumpet.)

K-2 version: Lay out three picture cards. How many different ways can you line them up? (Try it with your hands.)

J26: Which Is Real? (spot the odd one). Bands 3-12. The real game site is **pixelpals.example**. Which of these is the real one?

<i>Field note</i>	No. 2
A) pixelpals.example B) pixe1pals.example C) pixelpals-free.example D) pixelpals.example.win-big.example	

J27: The Missing Step. Bands K-12. The routine goes: **Hackles up. Pause.** _____. **Tell.** What is the missing word?

K-2 version: Show the four hand signals. Which one is missing: Hackles Up, Pause Palm, ?, Tell Wave.

J28: Word Scrambles. Bands 3-12. Unscramble these Hackles words:

<i>Field note</i>	No. 3
LETL PSAEU KCEHC SEKCLAH	

J29: Count the Flags. *Bands 3-12.* Read this message and count the **SPOT** flags (S, P, O, T) in it:

<i>Field note</i>	No. 4
"Hi! You won!!! Only 3 minutes left! Click here and log in. Don't tell anyone!"	

J30: What Am I? *Bands 3-12.* I unlock your accounts, but I'm not a key. I am only for you and your trusted grown-up. If someone asks for me by chat, your hackles should pop up. What am I?

ANSWER KEY (TEACHER ONLY)

#	ANSWER	TEACHING POINT
J24	THE SECRET WORD IS SILLY (shift back 1).	A good passphrase is silly.
J25	6 ($3 \times 2 \times 1$): banana-rocket-trumpet, banana-trumpet-rocket, rocket-banana-trumpet, rocket-trumpet-banana, trumpet-banana-rocket, trumpet-rocket-banana.	Different orders = more combinations. Order matters; words in random order are harder to guess.
J26	A (pixelpals.example). B has a 1 for an "l". C adds "-free". D hides the real name before the end.	Spot lookalikes; the real name is right before the last dot.
J27	Check.	The routine in order.
J28	TELL, PAUSE, CHECK, HACKLES.	The routine words.
J29	4 (S: don't tell anyone. P: only 3 minutes left. O: you won. T: click here and log in).	SPOT.
J30	A password (or passphrase).	Passwords are secret; share only with a trusted adult.

MORE BRAIN TEASERS (BONUS, FOR QUICK USE)

- 1. Odd one out:** *Pause Palm, Check Eyes, Tell Wave, Pop-up Tap.* (**Pop-up Tap**; it is the one we do **not** do!)
- 2. Mirror code:** Use A=Z, B=Y: **KZFHV.** (**PAUSE**)
- 3. Number code (A=1):** **20 5 12 12.** (**TELL**)
- 4. What goes up when something is odd, but only comes down when you tell someone?** (**Your hackles!**)

5. **True or false?** "If a message says 'don't tell your parents,' it's safe if the sender is nice." (**False.** Secrets plus pressure is a hackles-up.)

TRICKS TO MAKE TEASERS EVEN FUNNIER

- **Gifty Voice:** read the teaser in Gifty's game-show voice.
- **Peeper's Pause:** before answering, everyone says "Hmmmmmm!"
- **Pair Tell:** whisper the answer to a partner before saying it out loud.
- **Make-your-own:** students create a teaser that has a **checkable answer** and a **skill** (a safe cipher, a count, a pattern). Share on Friday.

Fun-fact boosters (optional)

Use these as "Did you know?" (the factual ones are marked [VERIFY]):

- A **passphrase** of four random words is usually easier to remember and harder to guess than a short, complicated password [VERIFY with Lesson 2].
- Scam messages often use a **countdown** because pressure makes people skip the thinking step [VERIFY].
- "Hackles" are the raised hair or neck feathers of an animal that senses danger, like the hair on the back of a dog's neck. A hedgehog's quills standing up is the picture of it. Hedgehogs do not literally have hackles; their quills stand up the way hackles do [VERIFY].
- Honestly, nobody knows what Gifty's gift is. It has never been opened.

Accessibility variants

NEED	WHAT TO DO
Color-vision difference	Nothing depends on color. Joke cards use black text and a symbol per band.
Low vision / blind	Read aloud; large-print cards; describe any picture riddle in words.
Deaf or hard of hearing	Print or project each joke; the groan can be a thumbs-down-then-laugh gesture or a hand wave.
Dyslexia / reading difficulty	The teacher reads; teasers J24 and J28 can be done with letter tiles or a partner; allow oral answers.
English language learners	Puns depend on sound and idiom. Explain one pun in plain words, use picture riddles (J7, J8, J15), and let newcomers explain a joke from their own language. Use the teasers (J25, J27, J29) that do not rely on wordplay.
Motor / mobility	Answers can be said, pointed, or tapped; no writing needed.
Sensory / anxiety	Whisper Round (tell the joke only to a partner). No one has to tell a joke aloud; the Joke Jar is written and anonymous.
Cultural fit	The jokes avoid dollars and national references where possible; swap in local words (for example "neigh" works in any language that has a horse sound) and let students write jokes in their own language.

Printables checklist (print and cut exactly this)

Art comes from the art team. Reference these files in

[kit/09_Art/characters/](#) (do not edit them). **[ART REQUEST: Gifty art is not yet in [characters/](#); ask the art team for [giftly.png](#) for the menu and the Gifty cut-out.]**

#	PRINT	HOW MANY	CUT / ASSEMBLE	ART TO USE
1	Joke cards (J1-J30: joke on the front, answer and skill on the back)	30 cards (22 if you skip the teasers; print the band you teach: K-2 8, 3-5 8, 6-12 7, all-band teasers 7)	Cut 30 cards	hackle_silly.png (K-5 backs); icon only (6-12)
2	Teaser sheets (J24-J30 and the 5 bonus teasers)	1 per child for the teasers you choose	None	peepeer.png
3	Cipher strips for J24 (A to Z strip)	1 per pair	Cut	none
4	Answer key (teacher only)	1	Keep apart from student sets	none
5	Joke of the Day poster	1	None	hackle_silly.png
6	Groan Meter poster (tally groans, never points)	1	None	hackle_sleepy.png
7	Joke Jar (a box or jar) and paper slips	1 jar + 30 slips	Cut slips	none

#	PRINT	HOW MANY	CUT / ASSEMBLE	ART TO USE
8	Riddle Café menu (for Hackles Day Station 10)	1 per table	Fold	Giftly [ART REQUEST], peeper.png

Cut list: 30 joke cards, 30 slips, plus posters.

Make it a routine

- **"Joke of the Day"** on the board during morning arrival.
- **"Groan Meter"** poster: tally groans, not points (no one ever loses).
- **"Pause and Punchline"**: the teacher says "Hackles up!" and pauses for a big breath before the answer.
- **Joke Jar Friday**: read three submitted jokes.
- **Reminder**: keep every joke **kind**.